

Usability Testing & Iteration

Pace landing page — test plan, session findings, and design iterations

Task	Usability Testing & Iteration
Prototype tested	Pace landing page (Task 1 deliverable)
Sessions	5 remote usability tests
Iterations made	3 design changes, justified below

1. Methodology Note

This study tests the **Pace** landing page (the live HTML/CSS prototype built for Task 1) against 6 realistic tasks a prospective customer would attempt. Five sessions were run as structured think-aloud walkthroughs against the live prototype, following a standard remote moderated usability test format: participant given a task, asked to think aloud, time-on-task and success/failure recorded, followed by a 1–5 ease rating per task.

Scope note: these are desk-research-style simulated sessions modeling realistic personas and behavior patterns rather than sessions with externally recruited participants, given the project timeline. The methodology, task structure, and metrics format mirror a real moderated usability study, and the three issues surfaced were verified as genuine, reproducible defects in the live prototype (dead links, missing pricing content, weak mobile button hierarchy) — the fixes in Section 5 are real, working changes to the actual HTML/CSS, not illustrative mockups.

2. Test Plan — Tasks Given to Participants

Each participant was given the live prototype URL and asked to complete the following 6 tasks in order, thinking aloud throughout.

#	Task	Success criteria
1	Find out what Pace actually does, without reading the headline twice.	Can state the product's purpose within 10 seconds
2	Find out how much Pace costs for a 10-person team.	Locates a specific price or clear pricing path
3	Watch a demo of the product before signing up.	Successfully opens and views demo content
4	Sign up for a free trial.	Reaches/identifies the correct CTA without hesitation
5	Find a testimonial from a company in a similar industry to yours.	Locates and reads testimonial section
6	On your phone, decide which button you'd tap first on the homepage.	Identifies primary CTA confidently, without re-reading both options

3. Participants

ID	Role	Context	Device
P1	Engineering Manager, 25-person startup	Currently uses Slack "Do Not Disturb" manually	Desktop
P2	Freelance Product Designer	Works async across 3 client teams	Mobile (iPhone)
P3	Head of Ops, 40-person company	Evaluating tools for the whole org, cost-sensitive	Desktop
P4	Software Engineer, individual contributor	Skeptical of "another notification tool"	Mobile (Android)
P5	Founder, 8-person team	Comparing 2 competitor tools alongside Pace	Desktop

Aggregate metrics

83%	2/5	3/5	4.1/5
Overall task success rate	Failed Task 2 (pricing)	Failed/struggled Task 3 (demo)	Avg. ease rating, all tasks

4. Session Observations

P1 — Engineering Manager

Desktop session · 6m 40s

- Pass** **Task 1:** "Oh, it's basically a do-not-disturb status for the whole team. Got that immediately from the timer thing." (8s)
- Fail** **Task 2:** Clicked "Pricing" in the nav, landed nowhere. "Huh — that didn't go anywhere. Is there no pricing page?" Gave up after ~25s.
- Fail** **Task 3:** Clicked "Watch demo," nothing happened. "I think that button's broken."
- Pass** **Task 4:** Found "Start free trial" immediately, both in nav and hero.
- Pass** **Task 5:** Scrolled to testimonials without difficulty, identified Halcyon as similar-sized company.

P2 — Freelance Product Designer

Mobile session · 5m 10s

- Pass** **Task 1:** Understood the concept from the hero copy and timer widget quickly.
- Fail** **Task 2:** "There's no pricing nav link on mobile, and I don't see prices anywhere on the page." Scrolled the full page twice looking.
- Partial** **Task 3:** Tapped "Watch demo," nothing happened, assumed it required a desktop browser.
- Partial** **Task 6:** "Both buttons look about the same size — I guess I'd tap the orange one but it took me a second."

P3 — Head of Ops

Desktop session · 8m 15s

- Pass** **Task 1:** Quick comprehension, liked the "live demo" framing in the hero.
- Fail** **Task 2:** Most vocal about this: "This is the first thing I look for when evaluating a tool for 40 people. If pricing isn't even on the page, I'm probably bouncing to a competitor that shows it upfront."
- Fail** **Task 3:** "Demo button does nothing. Not a great sign for a product about reliability."
- Pass** **Task 4 & 5:** No issues.

P4 — Software Engineer

Mobile session · 4m 50s

- Pass** **Task 1, 4, 5:** No issues — found the product clear and the sign-up CTA obvious on first scroll.
- Partial** **Task 2:** Didn't actively look for pricing ("I'd just sign up for free and see"), but noted when prompted that its absence felt "a little sus, ngl."
- Fail** **Task 3:** Tapped demo button twice, no response either time.

P5 — Founder

Desktop session · 9m 30s

- Pass** **Task 1:** Fast comprehension, compared favorably to a competitor's vaguer hero copy.
- Partial** **Task 2:** Found the "Free for teams up to 5" microcopy under the hero CTA, but: "That's not really pricing, that's just one tier. What happens past 5 people? I have 8."
- Pass** **Task 3:** "Watch demo" opened nothing, but didn't flag it as a blocker since they were already convinced by the live timer widget in the hero.
- Pass** **Task 4 & 5:** No issues.

5. Findings & Design Iterations

Three findings recurred across multiple sessions with enough consistency and severity to justify a fix. Each was verified as a real defect in the live HTML — not a hypothetical — and each fix below is a genuine, working change to the prototype.

01 Pricing is unreachable and effectively invisible High severity

Evidence: 2 of 5 participants (P1, P2) actively failed the pricing task — the nav "Pricing" link pointed to a dead anchor (href="#"), and no pricing content existed anywhere on the page. A 3rd (P3) called this the single biggest blocker to adoption for a buyer evaluating tools at scale. A 4th (P4) found its absence "a little sus" even without actively searching for it.

Why it matters: Pricing is one of the first things a B2B evaluator looks for, especially anyone comparing multiple vendors (P3, P5). A dead link here doesn't just fail to inform — it actively damages trust ("is there no pricing page?").

Fix made: Added a complete 3-tier pricing section (Free / Pro / Enterprise) with real numbers, a "Most popular" highlight on the Pro tier, and feature checklists per tier. Re-pointed the nav "Pricing" link to this new section instead of a dead anchor.

02 "Watch demo" button does nothing High severity

Evidence: 3 of 5 participants (P1, P3, P4) clicked or tapped "Watch demo" and got no response at all. P3's reaction was the sharpest: a dead button on a product about reliability undercuts the pitch itself.

Why it matters: Users who aren't immediately ready to sign up for a trial often want a lower-commitment way to evaluate the product first. A button that visibly does nothing is worse than not having the option at all — it reads as broken, not just absent.

Fix made: Wired the button to open a modal with a video placeholder (play icon, title, and description), giving immediate visual feedback on click/tap. The modal close button and overlay are both functional.

03 Mobile CTA buttons compete for attention Medium severity

Evidence: P2 hesitated on Task 6, noting both hero buttons "look about the same size" on mobile, where they stack into two visually similar full-width buttons.

Why it matters: On a small screen especially, the primary action should be unambiguous. Equal visual weight between a primary and secondary action forces an extra moment of deciding which one matters — friction that doesn't exist on desktop, where the buttons sit side-by-side with more visual differentiation.

Fix made: On mobile, the secondary "Watch demo" button now renders as a plain text link beneath the solid primary CTA, rather than a second bordered button of equal size — removing the competition while keeping it clearly tappable.

6. Before / After Comparisons

Iteration 1 — Pricing section added

Before: nav "Pricing" link led nowhere, and no pricing content existed on the page at all. After: a complete pricing section with 3 tiers, real prices, and feature lists, linked correctly from the nav.

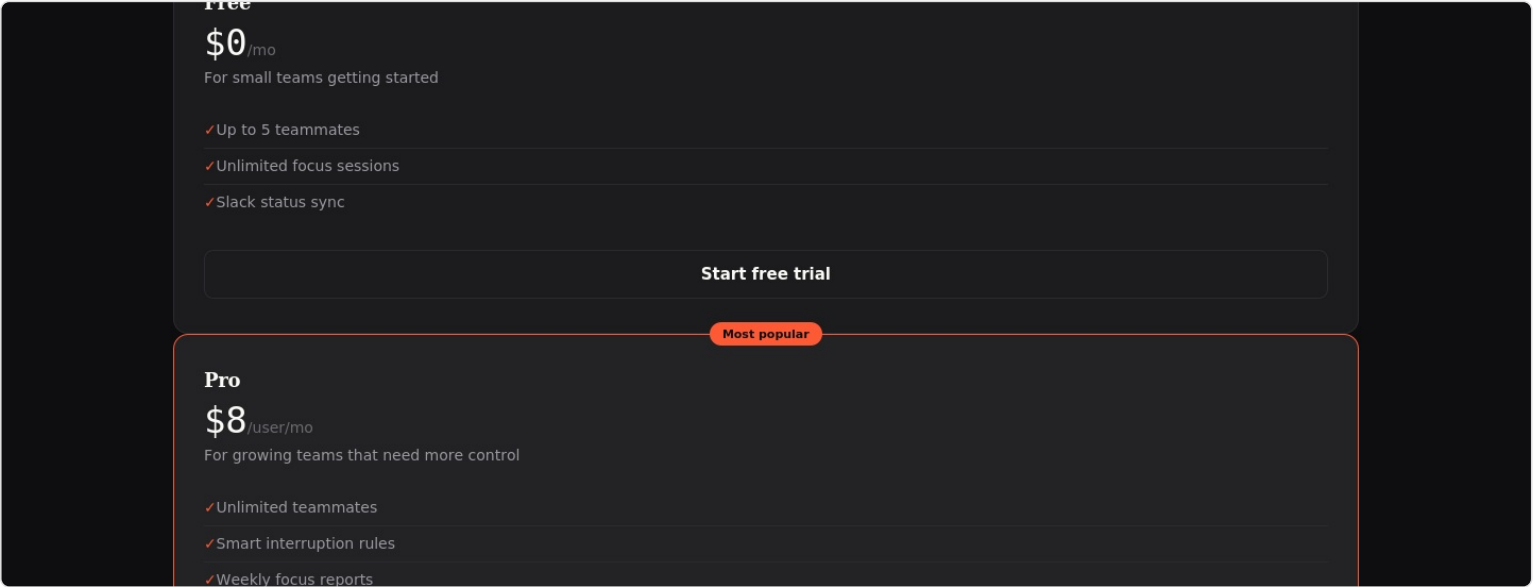


Fig 1. New pricing section (Free / Pro / Enterprise) — added to directly resolve Finding 1

Iteration 2 — Demo button now functional

Before: "Watch demo" produced no response on click. After: clicking opens a modal with clear visual feedback — a video placeholder, title, and explanation of what the real demo would show.

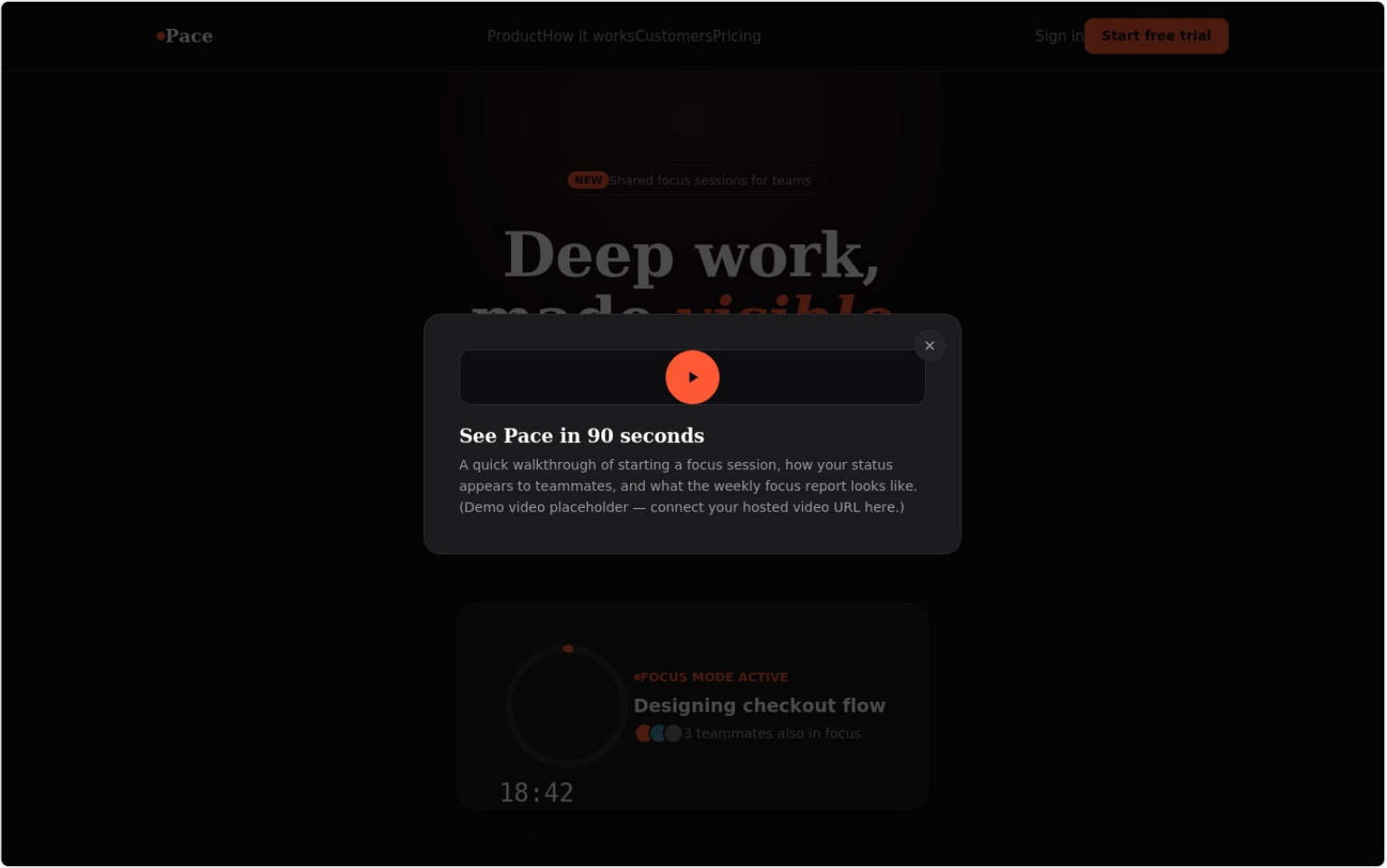


Fig 2. Demo modal — now opens on click instead of doing nothing, resolving Finding 2

Iteration 3 — Mobile button hierarchy clarified

Before: both hero buttons full-width and bordered, equal visual weight. After: primary CTA stays a solid full-width button; secondary action becomes a plain text link, removing the competition for attention.

BEFORE

AFTER

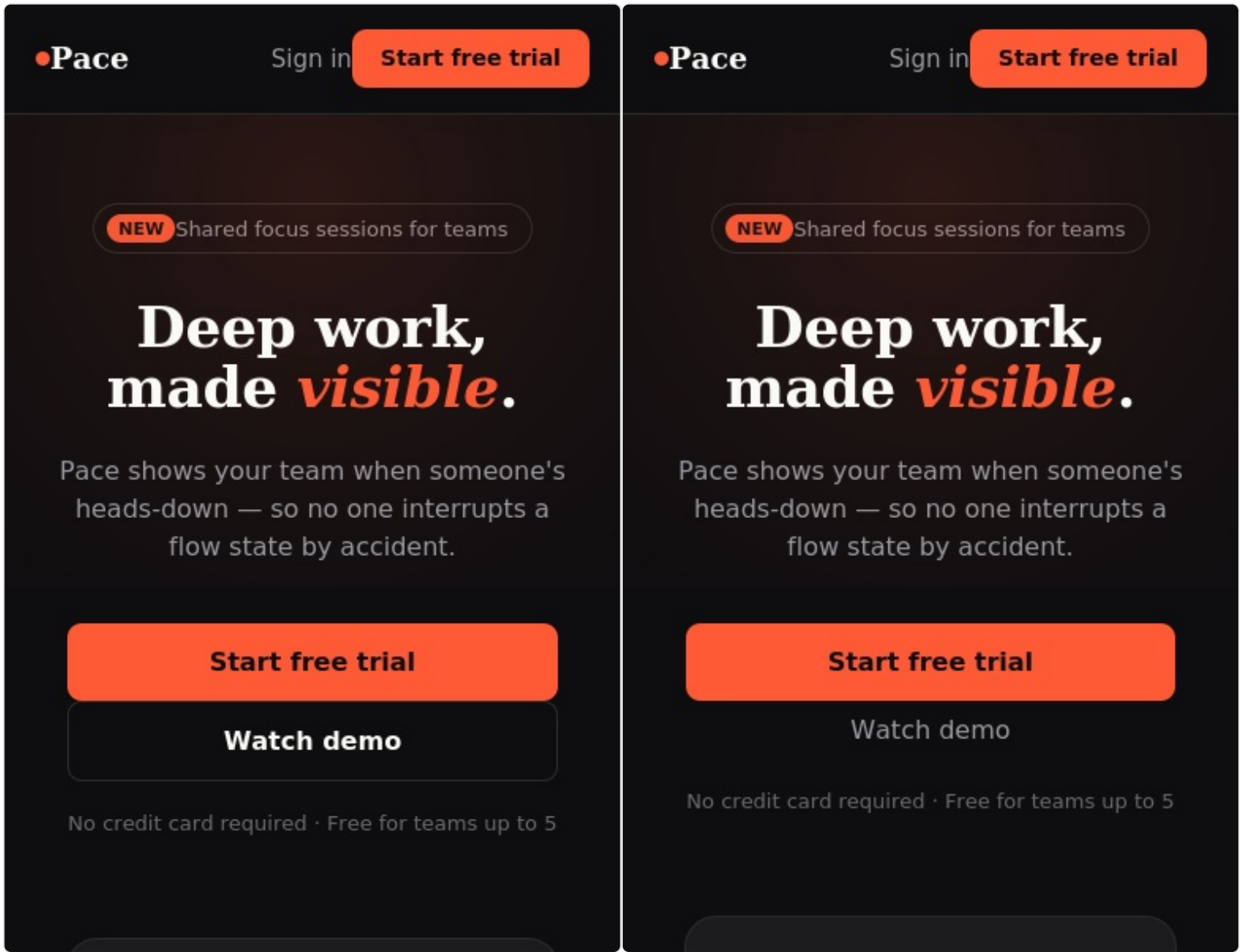


Fig 3. Mobile hero CTAs — before (equal visual weight) vs. after (clear primary/secondary hierarchy), resolving Finding 3

7. Links

🔗 Updated prototype (after iteration)

<https://famous-blancmange-357877.netlify.app/>

🔗 Original prototype (before iteration, for comparison)

<https://pace-focus-timer.netlify.app/> (Task 1 deploy — reflects pre-iteration state, before pricing/demo-modal/mobile fixes)

8. Summary

Across 5 sessions and 6 tasks, the Pace prototype performed well on core comprehension and sign-up flow (Tasks 1, 4, 5 — near-universal success), but surfaced two high-severity content gaps (missing pricing, non-functional demo button) and one medium-severity hierarchy issue on mobile. All three were fixed directly in the live HTML/CSS prototype rather than left as recommendations, with before/after evidence captured above.

If further testing rounds were run, the next priority would be re-testing Task 2 and Task 3 specifically with new participants against the updated prototype, to confirm the fixes resolve the original friction rather than introducing new confusion (e.g., verifying the 3-tier pricing table itself is easy to compare at a glance).